



SOUTHERN WHITE-FACED OWL
Ptilopsis granti
F: Strigidae

Like many other owl species, this bird of sub-Saharan Africa breeds in the stick nests of other birds.

22–24 cm
9–9½ in



STRIPED OWL
Pseudoscops clamator
F: Strigidae

A S. American eared owl, this species lives in open, marshy habitats and nests in ground vegetation or low tree-holes.

36 cm
14 in



NORTHERN HAWK-OWL
Surnia ulula
F: Strigidae

This relative of pygmy owls is found in subarctic forests. With its small head, long tail, and daytime activity, it is the most hawk-like owl.

36–45 cm
14–18 in



13–15 cm
5–6 in

ELF OWL
Micrathene whitneyi
F: Strigidae

Like other insect-eaters, this tiny Mexican desert owl does not need to fly silently, so it lacks the fringed, sound-muffling wing feathers of larger species.

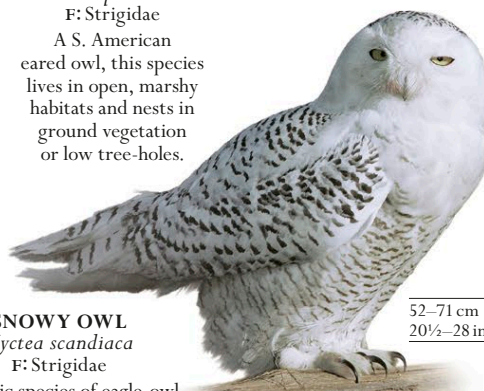
brilliant
yellow eyes



SPECTACLED OWL
Pulsatrix perspicillata
F: Strigidae

This is a distinctive species from C. and S. American forests. Its fledglings are white with a contrasting black face.

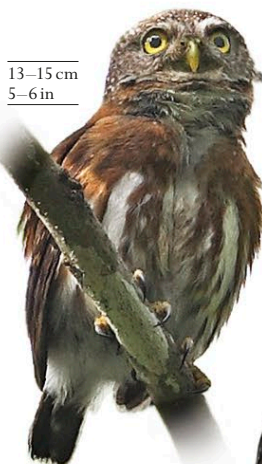
46 cm
18 in



SNOWY OWL
Nyctea scandiaca
F: Strigidae

An Arctic species of eagle-owl, this large, ground-nesting predator breeds on open tundra, where it feeds on lemmings and ptarmigan.

52–71 cm
20½–28 in



13–15 cm
5–6 in

LEAST PYGMY OWL
Glaucidium minutissimum
F: Strigidae

Like other related small owls, this woodland bird of Paraguay and S.E. Brazil is active during the day and night.



NORTHERN PYGMY OWL
Glaucidium gnoma
F: Strigidae

Pygmy owls often fearlessly tackle prey bigger than themselves. This little predator from western N. America has been seen attacking grouse.

15–17 cm
6–6½ in

17–18 cm
6½–7 in

FERRUGINOUS PYGMY OWL
Glaucidium brasilianum
F: Strigidae

Typical of pygmy owls, this American species has eyespots on the back of the head to confuse predators. It flicks its tail when excited.



15–18 cm
6–7 in

CUBAN PYGMY OWL
Glaucidium siju
F: Strigidae

Many owls nest in decayed tree cavities, but pygmy owls habitually choose old woodpecker holes. This species is restricted to Cuba.



long claws

46–47 cm
18–18½ in

BUFFY FISH OWL
Ketupa ketupu
F: Strigidae

This S.E. Asian relative of eagle-owls catches fish and other aquatic prey with the help of its long-clawed feet.